Learning to Compose

Recursive Self-Improvement of Shared Executable Stacks for Zero-Shot Long-Horizon Robot Manipulation

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GitHub: https://github.com/your-org/recursia

Project Page: https://example.com/recursia

ABSTRACT

Skills that succeed in isolation can fail when composed into a long-horizon robot task. Their tools may lack a required capability or report completion before execution has finished, and one skill may leave a state from which the next cannot reliably start. We introduce RECURSIA, a stack-aware, validation-gated recursive self-improvement framework for coding agents in zero-shot long-horizon robot manipulation. The framework targets compositional generalization by improving a shared executable stack across multiple levels: low-level tools, reusable skills with execution contracts, skill handoffs, and verification. Guided by failure attribution on source tasks, the agent generates missing tools or repairs shared components. Candidates must pass generality checks, mechanism-level tests, and paired regression tests before acceptance. The resulting stack is frozen and reused unchanged on target tasks through declarative adapters. This formulation makes the mechanism of transfer explicit: a repair learned from one source failure becomes executable functionality available to multiple skills and unseen compositions. We evaluate transfer from LIBERO-90 to LIBERO-Long-Pro using source-experience snapshots and comparisons with library-based program generation. [Draft: Insert verified primary results and costs. Add the isolated-versus-chained skill finding only after the planned handoff experiment is complete.]

1 Introduction

Long-horizon robot manipulation demands more than a repertoire of individually capable skills (Mees et al., 2021). Executing a pick-and-place action, for instance, is insufficient if it leaves the environment in a state that violates the preconditions of the subsequent skill (Xu et al., 2026). Grounding high-level language plans in skill affordances and perceptual geometry is therefore critical for physically feasible execution (Ahn et al., 2022; Huang et al., 2023). The central question is how skills acquired on source tasks can be composed to reliably solve previously unseen long-horizon target tasks.

Coding agents provide a natural testbed for studying this compositional generalization (Liang et al., 2023; Mu et al., 2024; Fu et al., 2026). Language-model-generated programs can invoke perception and control APIs, implement feedback loops, and reuse procedural abstractions (Liang et al., 2023). RoboCodeX further decomposes multimodal instructions into object-centric manipulation units and synthesizes control code (Mu et al., 2024), while ProgPrompt incorporates state-feedback assertions and recovery actions into generated plans (Singh et al., 2023). Skill-library systems such as Voyager store executable procedures and use environmental feedback for extension (Wang et al., 2023); ASPIRE combines execution feedback,

program refinement, skill discovery, and evolutionary search for manipulation (Lu et al., 2026). Lifelong Robot Library Learning expands skill repertoires from accumulated experience (Tziafas and Kasaei, 2024), and Uni-Skill requests new skill implementations when existing ones fall short (Xie et al., 2026). CaP-X examines how abstraction levels, perceptual grounding, and structured execution feedback affect the reliability of embodied coding agents (Fu et al., 2026). Although these capabilities make program improvement a promising route to transfer, reliable composition depends not only on the generated task program, but critically on the *shared interfaces* it invokes: tools, skill contracts, inter-skill state transfers, and verification logic. Thus, the central object of study shifts from *how* an agent writes a program to *which reusable execution semantics* that program inherits.

We identify four key obstacles to reliable composition: (1) **Tool insufficiency**, where a task requires a reusable capability absent from the initial API; (2) **Semantic misalignment**, where an existing tool returns normally despite failing to reach its requested pose of the next tool in the skill; (3) **State incompatibility**, where a skill's terminal state violates its successor's preconditions (Xu et al., 2026); and (4) **Verification brittleness**, where incorrect checks advance an unfinished task or disturb a completed goal. These failure modes correspond to different interfaces in a hierarchical controller: tool execution, skill completion, inter-skill state transfer, and verifiers. Prior systems acquire and reuse executable skills from experience (Wang et al., 2023; Tziafas and Kasaei, 2024; Lu et al., 2026), and execution-guided self-debugging demonstrates that failed programs yield useful repair evidence (Chen et al., 2024). The Darwin Gödel Machine extends this to persistent self-modification evaluated on coding benchmarks (Zhang et al., 2025). We investigate how repairs to shared interfaces with multiple layers can be validated and retained across tasks. We hypothesize that a repair at a shared interface should improve multiple compositions, whereas a task-specific patch should benefit only the trajectory in which it is written. We test this hypothesis through shared-stack versus task-program-only ablations.

We propose RECURSIA, a framework that targets compositional generalization by treating the *shared executable stack* as the primary object of persistent improvement. A coding agent can add missing tools, repair skill contracts, or improve handoffs and verifiers. Each modification becomes part of a versioned implementation reused by subsequent source tasks and frozen during target-task execution. Specifically, RECURSIA is stack-aware and validation-gated. Source-side execution traces identify the first violated requirement, attributing failures to specific repair layers. This attribution proposes a mechanism for change but does not itself establish efficacy. Candidates must satisfy restrictions on task-specific specialization, survive paired comparisons with the parent stack, and pass the validation gate with selection gate and regression gate. Accepted changes are retained with their failure class, validation evidence, and code version. Task variation is expressed through declarative adapters. At deployment, the frozen stack relies solely on permitted robot observations; evaluator-side ground truth used during source diagnosis is never an input to the deployed policy.

Our contributions are threefold: (1) We formulate skill composition as the persistent improvement of a *shared executable stack* integrating tools, skills with execution contracts, handoffs, and verifiers, and enable the generation of previously absent tools. (2) We introduce a failure-attributed improvement procedure that localizes repairs to specific stack layers and validates shared patches through generality and regression gates. (3) We evaluate zero-shot transfer of frozen stacks to unseen long-horizon compositions and perform detailed ablations to disentangle isolated skill competence, handoff reliability, and validation efficacy. [Draft: The dedicated handoff analysis is planned; update the contribution wording after its completion.]

2 Method

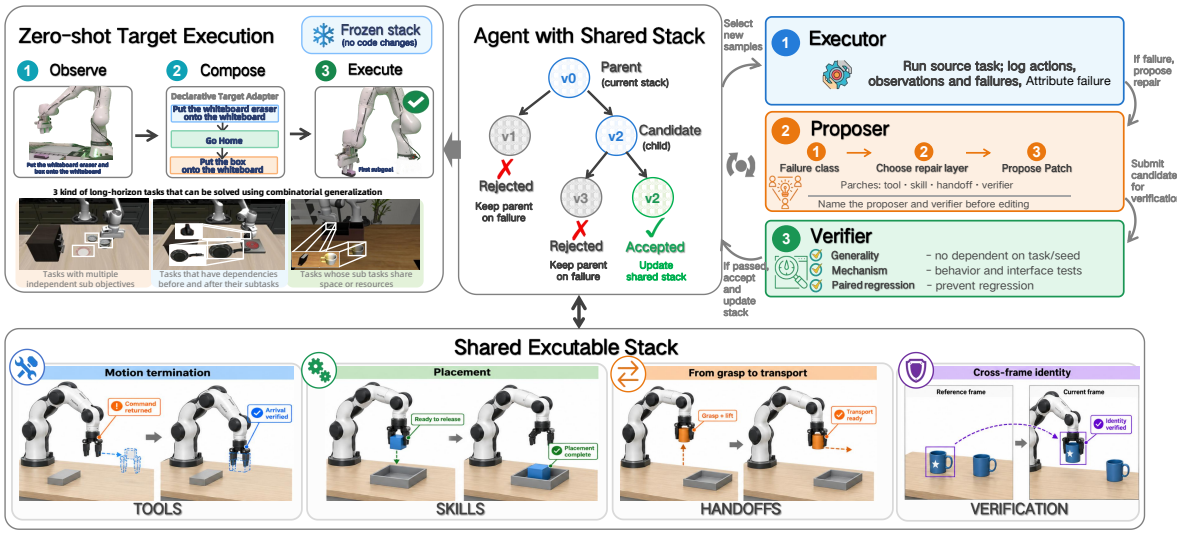


Figure 1: Framework overview. The improvement loop operates on four executable levels. Both newly generated tools and repairs to existing components must pass the same acceptance process before entering the shared stack. Target execution does not modify the stack.

2.1 Problem Formulation

Let $\mathcal{D}_{\text{src}}$ denote the source dataset available for improvement and $\mathcal{D}_{\text{tgt}}$ the target dataset used for frozen transfer. τ denotes one task. The goal is to obtain an executable shared stack through debugging with $\mathcal{D}_{\text{src}}$.

After k accepted modifications obtained from $\mathcal{D}_{\text{src}}$, the executable stack is

$$\mathcal{S}_k = (\mathcal{T}_k, \mathcal{K}_k, \mathcal{H}_k, \mathcal{V}_k), \tag{1}$$

where $\mathcal{T}_k$ contains tools, $\mathcal{K}_k$ reusable skills, $\mathcal{H}_k$ handoff mechanisms, and $\mathcal{V}_k$ verifier mechanisms. Learning and debugging occurs through changes and modifications to executable code; the foundation model is held fixed within a comparison. The declarative adapter a_τ provides object descriptions, support or destination descriptions, relation types, and goal dependencies. A shared executor composes calls to these components using a_τ and the available observation history $h_t = (o_0, u_0, \ldots, o_t)$. [Draft: Confirm the model configuration and adapter schema against the final experiment manifest.]

We use *zero-shot compositional transfer* to mean that target-task compositions do not provide feedback for stack modification, and the frozen stack is executed without target-specific code repair. Source and target tasks may share objects, relations, or individual skills.

2.2 Four-layer Shared Executable Stack

Tool. Tools expose reusable perception, geometry, planning, or execution operations. Their interfaces specify inputs, coordinate conventions, observable completion conditions, and resource limits. The tool set is extensible. When an attributed source failure reveals that no available operation can satisfy a required capability, the agent proposes a new shared tool rather than embedding a task-specific workaround in the adapter. A proposal defines the missing capability, an interface, the permitted observations it consumes, and tests of its intended behavior. New tools are assembled from the permitted lower-level operations and are registered only after validation. Tool generation cannot introduce privileged sensing at deployment or alter the external evaluator. We distinguish these additions from repairs to existing tools in the experimental analysis. Figure 2 illustrates representative interfaces.

Skill. A skill with execution contracts is represented by

$$K_i = (\text{Pre}_i, \pi_i, \text{Post}_i, B_i), \tag{2}$$

where Pre_i defines observable prerequisites, π_i is a parameterized program, Post_i specifies evidence required at completion, and B_i bounds resource use. Preconditions and postconditions refer to task arguments and measured geometry, not identities of benchmark tasks. Execution returns evidence and a reason for termination, allowing the caller to distinguish a completed motion from an established task relation. Contracts are executable checks, not formal guarantees of correctness in unobserved states.

Handoff. The completion of one skill does not imply readiness for the next:

$$\mathrm{Post}_i(h_t) \not\Rightarrow \mathrm{Pre}_{i+1}(h_t). \tag{3}$$

A handoff updates the state used by the successor, checks its prerequisites, and checks previously achieved relations that later actions could disturb. Depending on the observed failure, the shared executor may re-observe, invoke a bounded recovery, or stop. Recovery must establish the missing prerequisite before execution resumes. For instance, a completed release motion requires a subsequent retreat before the next grasp becomes executable. The handoff makes this transition explicit.

Verifier. The verification layer evaluates object identity and task-relevant relations from permitted observations and execution history. The external evaluator independently measures its errors; the internal evaluator's own output is never used as the ground-truth success label. The external evaluator's role is distinct from a motion tool's arrival check: reaching a pose does not establish that the intended object is supported by the intended surface. The external verification uses support geometry and object identity across observations to decide whether the evidence permits advancement or recovery.

Together, these levels define the unit of reuse. A validated tool can serve several skills, a skill can appear in several goal sequences, and a handoff or relation check can apply across tasks.

Figure 2 shows four representative shared interfaces. The layers group responsibilities within one executable stack.

2.3 Failure-Attributed Improvement Procedure

The executor run source rollouts and records actions, observations and robot state. Source diagnosis use simulator ground truth to distinguish failure mechanisms, while the deployed stack remains restricted to permitted observations. The attribution procedure identifies the earliest supported violation of an execution requirement and records its stage, evidence, and affected component. It distinguishes an absent capability from an incorrectly implemented one.

The coding agent receives this evidence and proposes a candidate modification δ. The proposal names the failure class, the stack level to modify, the intended repair, and the tests that would evaluate the repair. Examples in Figure 2 include adding a missing constrained-motion operation, preventing unexecuted planning candidates from changing later solves, or revising a handoff that starts its successor before transport has completed. The candidate repair modify an existing component of $\mathcal{S}_k = (\mathcal{T}_k, \mathcal{K}_k, \mathcal{H}_k, \mathcal{V}_k)$ or extend the inventory. For instance, the candidate repair can extend the tool inventory as follows:

$$\mathcal{S}' = \mathrm{Apply}(\mathcal{S}_k, \delta), \qquad \mathcal{T}' = \mathcal{T}_k \cup \{t_{\mathrm{new}}\} \quad \text{for an accepted tool addition.} \tag{4}$$

Only the shared tools are modified. Diagnostic procedures, retrieval, search code, data splits, and scoring rules remain fixed in this case. First-failure attribution guides where to intervene, while the mechanism tests and paired execution determine whether that intervention works.

2.4 Multidimensional Validation Gate

Candidate acceptance combines three types of evidence. Firstly, generality checks reject benchmark-specific specialization in shared code, including task or seed identifiers and object- or scene-specific

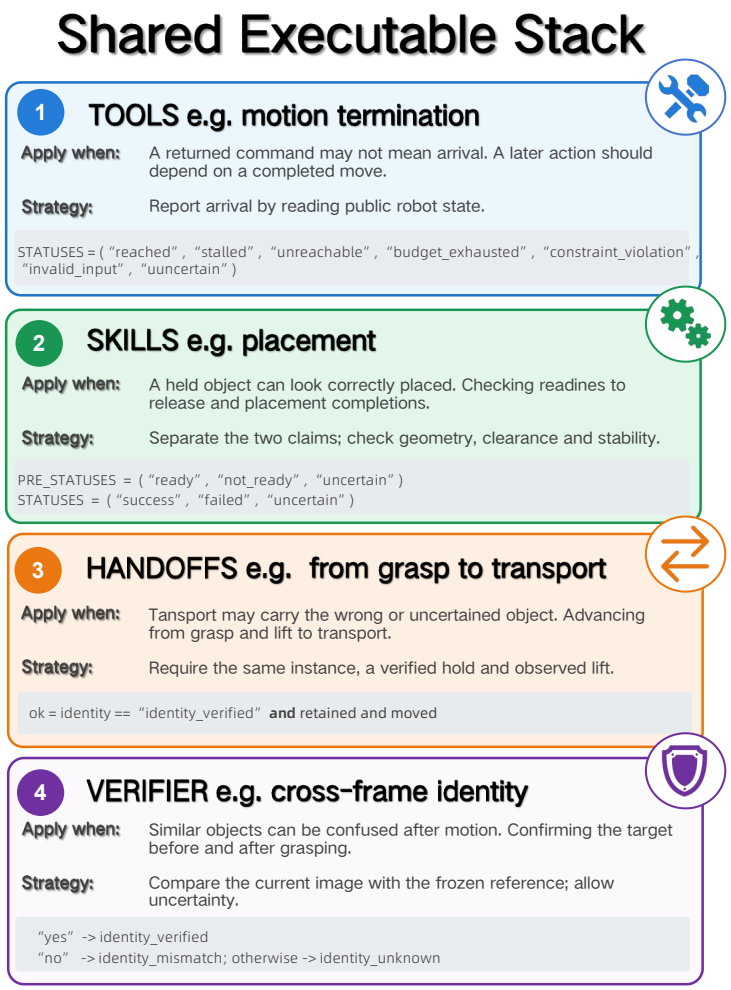


Figure 2: Representative shared-stack interfaces. [Draft: need xxx]

control branches. Geometric constants require a documented source, such as robot calibration, measured geometry, or a declared object-independent construction.

Secondly, mechanism tests check the proposed behavior before broader execution. Perception and verification patches can be replayed on recorded observations. Motion patches require execution tests, because an old trajectory does not reveal what a new controller would do. Tests also check interface compatibility and whether downstream actions respect failure returns. A newly generated tool must demonstrate both its intended capability and bounded handling of unsupported requests.

Finally, parent and candidate are compared on identical source-task states under a preregistered resource policy. Let $G(\delta)$ indicate the generality checks, $U(\delta)$ the mechanism tests, and $R(\mathcal{S}', \mathcal{S}_k; \mathcal{D}_{\text{sel}}, B)$ the paired performance and regression gate. Acceptance is

$$\text{Accept}(\delta) = G(\delta) \wedge U(\delta) \wedge R(\mathcal{S}', \mathcal{S}_k; \mathcal{D}_{\text{sel}}, B). \tag{5}$$

The gate considers the source-task success, regressions on other source tasks, and resource use. Exact thresholds and the allocation of development data, selection data, and audit data are specified with the experiment configuration. Rejected candidates do not replace the parent. Accepted candidates retain their code hash, source failure, tests, and paired results.

At inference time, all shared implementations are frozen. The target adapter specifies the requested composition, and execution logs identify the versions invoked by each subgoal.

Algorithm 1 RECURSIA Debugging Phrase

Require: Initial stack $\mathcal{S}_0$; source development task and selection tasks; budget B

$k \leftarrow 0$
for each source-task improvement step within budget **do**
  Execute $\mathcal{S}_k$ with a source-task adapter
  Attribute the first supported failure from aligned source traces
  Identify a missing capability or a faulty shared component
  Propose δ: generate a tool or repair the selected stack level
  $\mathcal{S}' \leftarrow \mathrm{Apply}(\mathcal{S}_k, \delta)$ in an isolated candidate version
  if generality checks and mechanism tests pass **then**
    Run parent-candidate paired development and selection tests
    if Multidimensional validation gates pass **then**
      $\mathcal{S}_{k+1} \leftarrow \mathcal{S}'$; archive repair evidence; $k \leftarrow k + 1$
    else
      Retain $\mathcal{S}_k$ and archive the rejection
    end if
  end if
end for
Inference: Execute target adapters using the frozen stack without target-driven repair

3 Experiments

Our experiments examine whether source-side improvement of a shared executable stack transfers to unseen long-horizon compositions and which levels of the shared stack contribute to transfer.

3.1 Experimental Setup

Setup. We use LIBERO-90 (Liu et al., 2023) for debugging, including failure diagnosis, repair generation, and candidate selection. Improvements persist in a versioned executable stack rather than in target-specific programs. All source-side development is completed before target evaluation, and the selected stack is frozen together with its tools, skill implementations, handoff logic, and verifiers. The coding model and its parameters remain fixed within each controlled comparison.

The first track evaluates the frozen stack on LIBERO-Pro Long, following the long-horizon transfer setting studied by ASPIRE (Zhou et al., 2025; Lu et al., 2026), with 10 long-horizon tasks evaluated along two axes. *Pos* changes initial object positions; *Task* changes the task specification. Each task–axis pair is evaluated on seeds 1–50, yielding 500 episodes per axis. The 10 task names and their axis-specific results are listed in Appendix D. The second track evaluates the frozen stack on simulated BEHAVIOR-1K (Li et al., 2024) tasks, a distinct manipulation benchmark with longer and more varied task specifications. The third track evaluates on a physical Franka FR3 equipped with a Franka Hand. Neither BEHAVIOR-1K episodes nor physical evaluation trajectories are used for stack repair or selection.

Baselines. We compare with OpenVLA (Kim et al., 2024), π_0 (Black et al., 2025), $\pi_{0.5}$ (Physical Intelligence et al., 2025), CaP-Agent0 (Fu et al., 2026), and ASPIRE (Lu et al., 2026). CaP-Agent0's published protocol regenerates programs per seed with test-time reasoning and retries, whereas ASPIRE fixes one program per task without target debugging; this difference is retained when interpreting the comparison. The *Human* row denotes expert-written robot programs, not human teleoperation. Human programs are finalized before evaluation and reused across the same seeds without evaluation-driven revision.

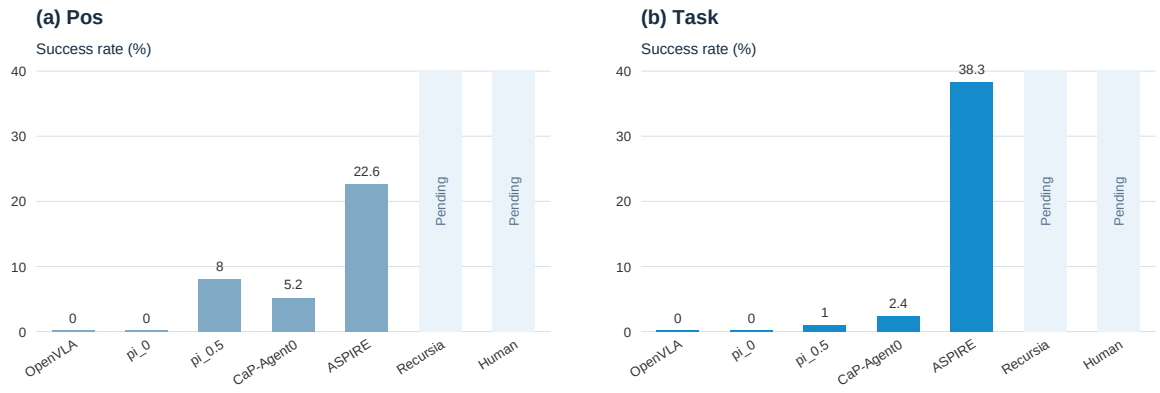


Figure 3: Zero-shot transfer to LIBERO-Pro Long. (a) Position perturbations (Pos). (b) Task-specification perturbations (Task). Baseline success rates are reproduced from the existing comparison; entries for RECURSIA and Human remain pending. Aggregate and per-task tables appear in Appendix D.

Metrics. We measure full-task success using the official benchmark evaluator. For task i and perturbation axis a, success is the fraction of successful episodes among its 50 evaluation states. Axis success is the unweighted mean over the 10 task rates; Overall is the mean of the Pos and Task macro-averages. Rates are reported on $[0, 1]$. Failures, timeouts, and program errors remain in the denominator. We report source-improvement costs separately from target-execution costs, including model input/output tokens, wall time, and perception calls. Matched reruns use identical initial states and report paired outcomes.

3.2 Zero-Shot Transfer to Long-Horizon Tasks

Figure 3 presents the primary zero-shot comparison separately for position (Pos) and task-specification (Task) perturbations. The source-experience scaling analysis is provided in Appendix D.3, Figure 7. Exact aggregate values are provided in Appendix D, Table **??**. We report separately frozen RECURSIA stacks after $N \in \{0, 25, 50, 90\}$ source tasks to examine how transfer changes with source-side experience. Each snapshot is selected using source data only and evaluated without target-driven modification. This comparison tests whether source-side changes to shared execution mechanisms remain useful when the target composition changes and no target feedback is available for repair. [Draft: Insert our aggregate results, uncertainty estimates, and interpretation after evaluation.]

3.3 Physical Robot Evaluation: Franka FR3 with Franka Hand

We compare RECURSIA with Skill Document Only (SD-only) on a Franka FR3 equipped with a Franka Hand. SD-only updates a single natural-language skill document, whereas RECURSIA updates a shared executable Python stack. Both use GPT-6 Astra, front and wrist observations, and the same six robot tools with SAM3 and Contact-GraspNet.

The six physical source tasks cover placing a mug or milk carton in a basket, placing white and blue mugs on the left and right plates, placing a plastic bowl on a plate, and placing a mug in the bowl. Each source task contributes three retained development rollouts. SD-only runs three passes through the source suite; RECURSIA groups the tasks into three two-task chunks, evaluating the current stack and two candidate updates on each pair.

The targets compose these actions: T1 places the mug and milk carton in the same basket; T2 places the blue mug on the left plate and the white mug on the right plate, reversing their source assignments; T3 first places the bowl on the plate, then the mug in the relocated bowl. Source knowledge is frozen before evaluation. Within-trial feedback corrections do not update persistent knowledge. Each target is evaluated three times per method, with at most 20 code blocks per trial. Task success is assessed manually.

Table 1: Success rates (%) on physical compositional target tasks using Franka FR3 with Franka Hand.

Task	SD-only	RECURSIA
T1: Shared basket	0.0	33.3
T2: Reassigned plates	66.7	66.7
T3: Bowl–mug dependency	0.0	100.0
Average	22.2	66.7

Table 2: Real-robot zero-shot transfer from LIBERO-90 debugging to real-robot execution on Franka FR3 with Franka Hand. For each task, we compare RECURSIA with the baseline approach ASPIRE. Success rates are calculated from xxx trials of the generated programs. Token counts are measured until the first success, or until the budget is exhausted for unsuccessful runs.

	Output Tokens (M) ↓		Total Tokens (M) ↓		Success Rate ↑	
	Baseline	RECURSIA	Baseline	RECURSIA	Baseline	RECURSIA
xxxxx	x	x	x	x	x/10	x/10
xxxxx	x	x	x	x	x/10	x/10
xxx	x	x	x	x	x/10	x/10
Average	x	∞	x	∞	TBD	TBD

Table 2 reports average success rates of 66.7% for RECURSIA and 22.2% for SD-only. Both achieve 66.7% on T2. The largest difference occurs on T3, where RECURSIA achieves 100% and SD-only achieves 0%. These preliminary results suggest a benefit from shared executable functionality for dependent task composition.

3.4 Ablation Study

We evaluate the three main components of RECURSIA through four configurations: the full method and three variants that separately/[Draft: incrementally] remove the learnable shared stack, failure-attributed improvement and multidimensional validation. The ablations use a common subset of LIBERO-Pro Long tasks, with 100 episodes.

Without Shared Stack. This baseline composes a fixed library of shared tools using the initial execution interfaces. The skill library remains learning throughout the source-task sequence. No new tools or persistent tool repairs are introduced. Comparison with the full method measures the benefit of improving the shared stack beyond reusing a fixed skill repertoire.

Without Failure-Attributed Improvement Procedure. This variant further removes structured first-failure attribution and attribution-guided repair-layer selection. The proposer receives the task outcome and ordinary execution feedback, and attempts shared code changes without an explicit failure-class or repair-layer recommendation. This comparison tests whether structured diagnosis helps identify useful shared repairs.

Without Multidimensional Validation Gate. This variant replaces the combined generality, mechanism-test, and paired regression gate with selection based on development-task success. Basic compilation and execution checks remain necessary to produce a runnable candidate, but do not constitute the removed gate. Selection uses source-side development evidence only. This comparison tests whether the full gate prevents locally beneficial changes from degrading frozen transfer.

Table 3 reports task success on the selected long-horizon tasks, source-side audit regressions, and

Configuration	Pos Perturbation	Task Perturbation
Full		
- Shared Stack		—
- failure-attributed improvement		
- multidimensional validation		

Table 3: Ablations study. The three ablations remove one component incrementally.

improvement cost. [Draft: Insert the results.]

3.5 Analysis of Compositional Generalization

The RECURSIA framework targets compositional generalization, combining knowledge from multiple source tasks to enable zero-shot transfer to long-horizon target tasks. This subsection aims to demonstrate this capability through retrospective case studies. Compositional transfer requires both competent constituent skills and compatible states at their boundaries. To disentangle improvements in individual skills from those in compositional ability, we examine this distinction through retrospective execution cases, separating two events: completion of the predecessor's goal and establishment of the successor's prerequisites. In particular, while the predecessor task is complete in the current state, this does not guarantee that the next object can be readily identified, reached, or manipulated. A useful diagnostic is the difference between isolated and chained success:

$$\Delta_{\text{chain}} = p_{\text{success}}^{\text{isolated}} - p_{\text{success}}^{\text{chained}} \tag{6}$$

This quantity measures sensitivity induced by composition capability.

Improving isolated skills does not remove the downstream bottleneck. At $N = 55$, the standalone stove-on operation improved from $0/10$ to $10/10$ on both development and selection datasets, whereas the stove-pan composition remained $0/10$. In the inspected development rollouts, the stove-on predicate became *True*, but subsequent manipulation lost the pan after a grasp attempt; alternative candidates were also rejected as outside the inverse-kinematics workspace. Thus, the rotary repair improved the first operation without establishing the conditions needed to complete the second. This comparison locates the remaining bottleneck and shows the difference between isolated and chained success. Our approach filled this gap by handoff repair mechanism, in the later iterations.

Relational success and successor readiness are distinct. In the $N = 30$ mug-pudding sequence, the mug-on-plate predicate became *True* in all ten `Pos` episodes, while the full conjunction succeeded in only one. In seed 42, the mug goal became *True* at step 573 and remained *True*, but subsequent pudding binding returned `not_found`. Seed 41 provides a successful contrast: the mug goal became *True* at step 552 and the pudding goal at step 1440, with the first goal preserved (Figure 4). A drawer sequence exhibits the same failure structure: seed 48 achieved bowl containment, but closing stopped at `part_not_found`. These traces identify perceptual binding as a prerequisite that is not certified by predecessor goal completion.

Together, these cases distinguish failures of successor execution from failures to establish successor readiness. The observed mug-pudding failure belongs to the second category, with the first goal preserved; the stove-pan failure exposes downstream manipulation limitations after stove-on succeeds. These evidence supports a conclusion: predecessor completion and successor readiness must be examined separately and processed by the handoff mechanism.

3.6 Analysis of Inference Methods

All inference methods are driven by declarative adapters. We compare three inference drivers over the same frozen shared stack: rule-based driver, one-shot task-program driver, and online closed-loop driver. These

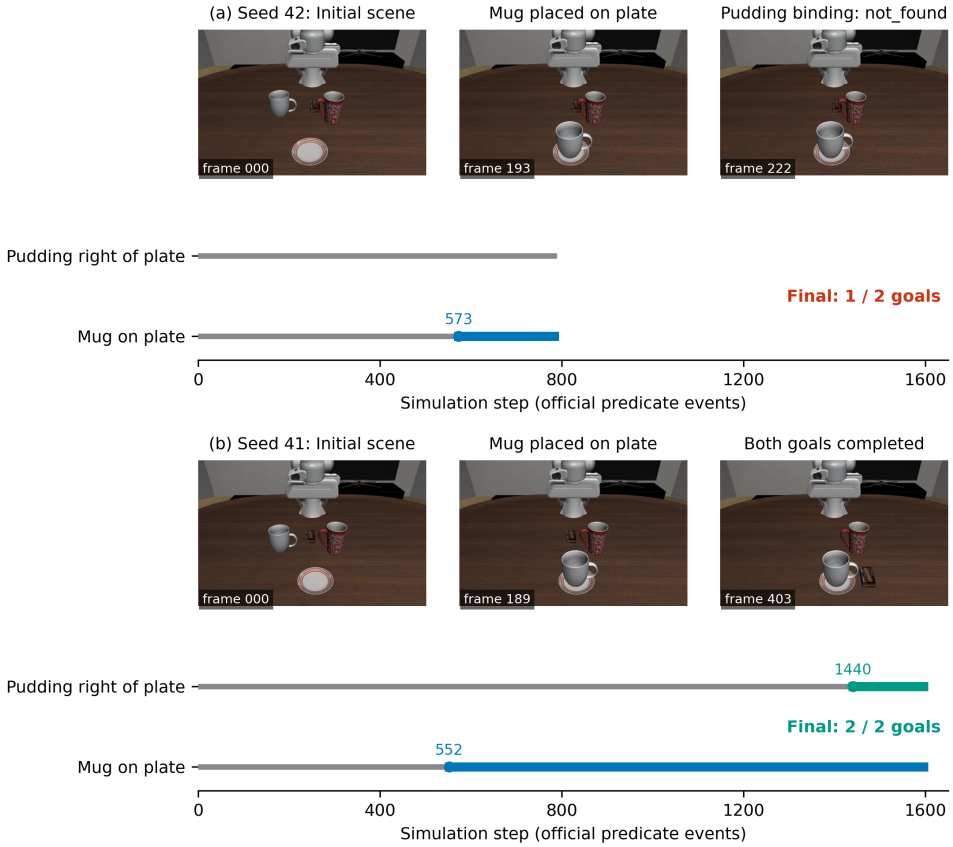


Figure 4: Recorded compositional generalization cases. Original RGB recordings and official predicate timelines for the N=30 mug–pudding sequence. (a) Seed 42 completes the mug goal, but pudding binding returns `not_found`; the earlier goal remains true through termination. (b) Seed 41 completes both goals while preserving the first. Gray segments denote false predicates; blue and teal segments denote true predicates. Across ten swap-suite episodes, the mug predicate is true at termination in all ten, whereas the full conjunction succeeds in one. The two illustrated seeds have different initial states. RGB frame identifiers and simulation-step timestamps use separate counters.

drivers differ in how high-level execution decisions are specified and updated. The rule-based driver follows predefined decision rules. The one-shot task-program driver executes an initially generated program, which may include observation-dependent branches and bounded retries. The online closed-loop[1] driver conditions subsequent decisions on observations and execution outcomes throughout the episode. All three may use observation feedback and closed-loop low-level control. The results are shown in Figure 5. One-shot generation describes the lifetime of the program, rather than an absence of feedback during its execution. In ASPIRE's zero-shot setting, task-program generation excludes target-side debugging, but the one-shot generated program may still re-observe the scene and use closed-loop low-level control (Lu et al., 2026). Here, we use the frozen shared stack.

The online closed-loop driver outperforms the one-shot task-program driver. The comparison between the online closed-loop driver and one-shot task-program driver is more limited. After multiple tries, the online closed-loop driver always gains more successful trajectories. The trajectories show that the drivers have different failure and success profiles. It reveals that the closed-loop decision making may resolve failures encountered by a fixed generated program while introducing other failures.

Feedback incurs latency without uniform gains across perturbation axes. The rule-based, one-shot, and closed-loop drivers achieve Pos success rates of 12%, 16%, and 16%, and Task success rates of 24%,

[1]The label "closed-loop" here denotes the inference driver's decision process, rather than a property exclusive to its low-level robot controller.

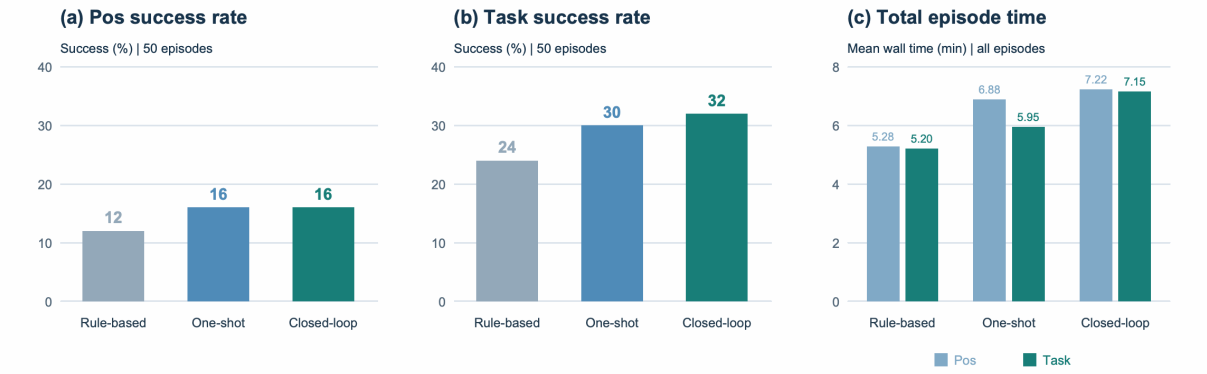


Figure 5: Inference-driver comparison on a frozen stack of the $N = 65$ iteration. (a) `Pos` and (b) `Task` success rates, each 50 matched episodes. (c) Mean end-to-end episode time, including program generation and robot execution, for all episodes.

30%, and 32%, respectively. Mean end-to-end episode times are 5.28, 6.88, and 7.22 minutes on Pos, and 5.20, 5.95, and 7.15 minutes on Task (Figure 5). These durations include generation and execution, with runtime model latency counted within execution; failures and timeouts remain in the averages.

Feedback-condition mechanism incurs latency without uniform gains across perturbation axes. Mean end-to-end episode times are 5.28, 6.88, and 7.22 minutes on `Pos`, and 5.20, 5.95, and 7.15 minutes on `Task`. These durations include generation and execution, with runtime model latency counted within execution; failures and timeouts remain in the averages. Relative to one-shot generation, closed-loop inference adds approximately 21 seconds per `Pos` episode, and 72 seconds per `Task` episode for a two-percentage-point gain. The incremental benefit is therefore concentrated in `Task` perturbations, whereas the `Pos` results do not show an aggregate improvement from additional feedback-conditioned decisions. Relative to the rule-based driver, one-shot generation gains four and six percentage points at additional mean costs of approximately 96 and 45 seconds on `Pos` and `Task`. In this comparison, much of the observed success improvement is already obtained by one-shot orchestration.

3.7 Analysis of the Validation Gate

The RECURSIA framework incorporates two critical validation components for the validation gate, i.e., the *selection gate* and the *regression gate*, to address two distinct risks: a candidate may correct a local mechanism without improving overall task completion (mitigated by the selection gate), or improve aggregate completion while disrupting previously successful states (mitigated by the regression gate). This subsection uses retrospective case studies to demonstrate their effectiveness. In the book-transfer task, the development summary reported candidate-filter rejection in eight of ten episodes for early iterations $N = 40$. Inspecting the earlier execution revealed a defect: the robot had already grasped and lifted the intended book, but a post-lift visual query selected a similar book that remained on the table. The low re-detected position was treated as evidence of a failed lift, causing the gripper to open and subsequent grasp attempts to fail. The subsequent iterations attempt to repair this identity check. We employ the validation framework to ensure the recognition of a known stationary competitor following a verified lift, while preserving the existing motion and hold checks.

Selection gate rejects candidates with insufficient improvement on the selection dataset. A repair during $N = 45$ changed the transport-to-descent boundary for book insertion so that entry into the opening remained under contact-aware control. Development release refusals attributed to the lateral corridor decreased from 8 to 2, and most tests passed. Nevertheless, official completion improved only from $0/10$ to $1/10$ in the development dataset and remained $0/10$ in the selection dataset, below the predeclared

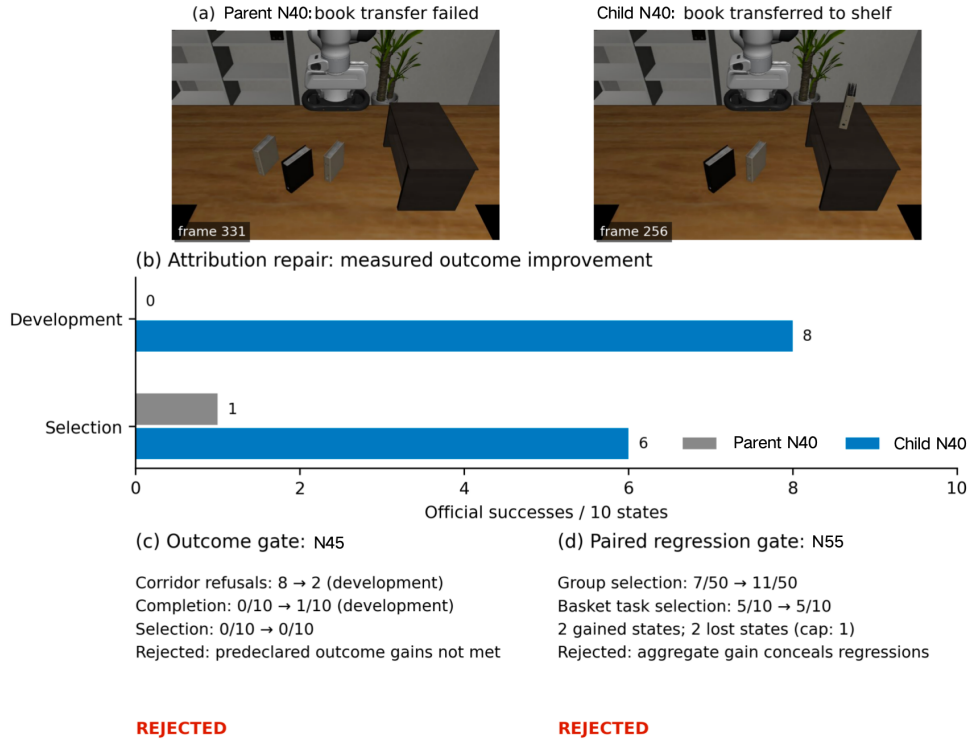


Figure 6: Recorded validation-gate cases. (a) Initial state. Original simulator frames from the N=40 iteration, both with seed 86. (b) Development and selection successes for this task. (c) The iteration N=45 reduced a local failure mechanism but failed the predeclared outcome gains. (d) The iteration N=55 improved the aggregate selection score while losing two previously successful basket-placement states, exceeding the per-task loss cap.

gains of two and one successes, respectively. The reason is that removing a prominent failure mechanism exposed remaining arrival, contact, and grasp failures. Although the candidate passed the paired-loss checks, it was rejected by the selection gate for insufficient improvement on the selection dataset.

Regression gate prevents aggregate gains from concealing lost successes. The N=55 iteration increased development completion from $2/50$ to $3/50$ and selection completion from $7/50$ to $11/50$. However, one basket-placement task retained its selection total of $5/10$ by gaining two states and losing two previously successful states. The two losses exceeded the per-task cap of one, and the candidate was rejected by the regression gate. Development book-insertion corridor refusals also fell from nine to zero without producing a completed insertion. These cases motivate checking trajectories, outcomes and paired losses in addition to aggregate development scores (Figure 6).

3.8 Analysis of Tool Repair and Tool Generation

Table 4 summarizes representative entries and shows generated repairs extend the callable inventory. The N=50 iteration added support-instance and placement semantics for previously refused `front/middle` relations, reusing the existing instance selector and placement primitives. Instruction dispatch coverage increased from $81/90$ to $84/90$, and the `front-of-mug` task improved from $0/10$ to $8/10$ in development dataset and $0/10$ to $7/10$ in selection dataset. The N=55 iteration subsequently generated a shared `run_rotary` driver that served both turn-on and turn-off instructions, corrected the pinch frame, and re-anchored turn increments on the executed tool pose. Twenty tests passed, and the driver was invoked in both standalone stove activation and the stove–pan sequence.

Entry	Failure	Repair	Recorded Result
N=50	Lack of front/middle reference relations	Shared instance selection and relation dispatch	Dispatch $81/90 \rightarrow 84/90$; gains measured on source tasks.
N=55	Rotary localization, pinch, and arc defects	Shared turn-on/off driver	Turn-on $10/10$ in each panel.

Table 4: Representative repairs. Rates refer to the specified tasks, not the complete Long-Pro benchmark.

4 Related Work

Embodied Agents. Language-guided robot agents connect high-level reasoning to physical execution through learned action models or executable programs. Vision-language-action models (VLA) such as RT-2, OpenVLA, and π series map visual observations and language instructions to robot actions (Brohan et al., 2023; Kim et al., 2024; Black et al., 2025). Programmatic approaches instead express control through calls to perception and action interfaces. Code as Policies composes these calls into robot programs and recursively generates missing helper functions (Liang et al., 2023), while ProgPrompt grounds plan generation in programmatic descriptions of available actions and objects (Singh et al., 2023). CaP-X extends this setting with systematic evaluation of coding agents, structured execution feedback, and automatic skill synthesis (Fu et al., 2026). Together, these approaches provide the building blocks for language-guided manipulation. RECURSIA focuses on how those building blocks improve across tasks: it persistently modifies the shared tools, skills, handoffs, and verifiers that generated programs invoke.

Embodied Recursive Self-Improvement. A central question in recursive self-improving agents is where experienc and knowledge is retained and how it changes subsequent behavior. The Darwin Gödel Machine retains improvements in the agent's own code and evaluates successive variants on coding benchmarks (Zhang et al., 2025). In robotics, Eureka uses language models to generate reward functions for policy learning (Ma et al., 2024), while evolutionary code search directly synthesizes executable control policies (Guo et al., 2026). Skill-library approaches retain experience as reusable procedures. Voyager accumulates executable skills in Minecraft (Wang et al., 2023); Lifelong Robot Library Learning bootstraps composable skills for robot control (Tziafas and Kasaei, 2024); and Uni-Skill requests new implementations when its existing repository cannot support a plan (Xie et al., 2026). These approaches make accumulated experience available to later tasks through improved policies, programs, or skill repertoires. ASPIRE (Lu et al., 2026) brings execution-driven repair and skill accumulation into a continual robot-programming loop. It uses execution traces to diagnose failures, distills validated fixes into a transferable skill library. Its evaluation includes transfer to unseen long-horizon tasks, making it the closest precursor to RECURSIA. Zero-shot transfer is also studied in the context of lifelong learning (**?**), where a robot learns to perform new tasks without additional training. RECURSIA differs from these approaches by focusing on the shared executable stack as the unit of improvement, allowing for more systematic and reusable repairs across tasks.

Compositional Generalization for Robotics. Compositional generalization requires familiar capabilities to remain effective when objects, goals, or action sequences are combined in new ways. CLIPort studies language-conditioned manipulation through semantic and spatial abstractions (Shridhar et al., 2021), and VIMA evaluates progressively more novel combinations of task components (Jiang et al., 2022). At longer horizons, CALVIN evaluates sequences of language-conditioned manipulation tasks (Mees et al., 2021), while LIBERO studies knowledge transfer across spatial, object, goal, and task variations (Liu et al., 2023). LIBERO-PRO adds perturbations to initial object positions and task specifications (Zhou et al., 2025). These evaluation settings expose several dimensions of transfer, from recognizing a new combination of familiar concepts to executing a sequence under changed conditions.

Reliable sequence execution also depends on the states passed between skills. BATON addresses this dependency by exploring subtasks separately and storing transition-aware memory: verification checks readiness, handoff restoration repairs entry conditions, and lookahead favors outcomes that the next subtask can use (Xu et al., 2026). Its treatment of transitions makes explicit why a skill can succeed in isolation yet fail as part of a chain. RECURSIA places this dependency within a broader stack-improvement problem. Handoff repairs are validated alongside changes to tools, skill contracts, and verification, and their shared implementations are reused unchanged on target compositions. Our evaluation therefore examines both the competence of individual skills and the reliability of their composition, tracing transfer to source-side changes in the executable stack.

5 Limitations and Conclusion

Our evaluation has several limitations. First, source-side ground-truth diagnosis provides information that may not be available on a physical robot. In simulation, failed episodes can be reset to a controlled initial state and replayed repeatedly. On a physical robot, resetting the scene can be slow, unsafe, or impossible after an object has moved, and the diagnostic evidence needed to identify the first violated requirement is often incomplete or expensive to obtain. Deployment does not consume simulator ground truth, but transferring the improvement procedure itself to real hardware therefore requires reliable alternatives, such as calibrated state logging, external sensing, human annotations, or conservative uncertainty handling. Second, we have not evaluated cross-embodiment generalization. All source and target experiments use the same robot embodiment and execution interfaces. A shared repair may depend on kinematics, gripper geometry, controller conventions, or calibration details, so transfer across robot platforms remains untested.

We present a framework for improving the shared executable mechanisms through which coding agents compose robot skills. The stack can grow when a required tool is missing and change when existing tools, contracts, handoffs, or verification fail. Source failure attribution directs these changes, while validation gates determine which changes persist. Frozen reuse then connects a source-side modification to the code executed in an unseen long-horizon composition. [Draft: Close with the verified empirical finding once the full-study tables and the planned handoff experiment are available; do not claim general compositional reliability from pilot results.]

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A Debugging Pipeline

This appendix documents the partial artifact, including the implementation description. The debugging pipeline separates proposal generation from evaluation. The verifier runs a frozen parent, records public observations and simulator/physical diagnostics, and supplies development evidence to one proposer. The proposer diagnoses a failure, makes several proposals, modifies shared code, replays the proposed decisions offline, and supplies tests. The verifier builds only after the final report, checks the candidate, runs a fixed paired plan, and records acceptance or rejection. An accepted program becomes the next parent; a rejected candidate leaves the parent unchanged. The prompt boxes reproduce templates and partial excerpts. Deployment-specific paths and login fields are replaced by `$ASPIRE_ROOT`, `<user>`, and `<server>`; typographic punctuation is normalized. Braced variables are filled by the coordinator. These are implementation records, including their historical restrictions.

A.1 Shared-Stack Proposer

The proposer receives the frozen program, running log, failure attribution, descriptor data, and patch-building interface. Its output is one shared-module change, with diagnosis and offline evidence preceding simulation. The nine builder module labels are `motion_preconditions`, `grasp_geometry`, `hold_contract`, `place_primitive`, `verifier`, `binding`, `language_adapter`, `manipulation_primitive`, and `task_driver`. These labels support attribution and dependency checks across the four conceptual layers.

Shared-Stack Proposer

Role. You are the proposer in a recursive self-improvement loop. Repair one reusable component of a shared robot program from source-task failures.
Evidence. You receive the following message:

- Frozen parent program
- Development failure attribution
- Recorded public observations
- Descriptor data
- Patch interface

Simulator truth may be used to diagnose failures and evaluate offline replay, but must never enter the executable policy.
Procedure. Choose one failure class that a coherent shared change can address across the development tasks. Identify the first violated requirement and the responsible module. Write the diagnosis before the patch. Replay the parent and candidate decisions on the recorded observations, and check that previously passing decisions remain unchanged. Derive new constants from measured geometry or documented robot quantities.
Constraints. Produce one task-agnostic patch to one declared module. Declare all affected dependencies. Use public robot and perception APIs. Read task facts from descriptors rather than embedding task, object, scene, color, or seed identifiers. Do not run policy episodes or tune constants to episode outcomes. Write only within the assigned proposal workspace.
Deliverables. Return the diagnosis, patch, offline replay and its results, and meaningful tests. The final report must state the failure class, modified module, proposed mechanism, evidence, test results, unresolved limitations, and artifact locations. The evaluator builds the candidate only after this report.

A.2 Verifier

The "verifier" role is implemented by deterministic checks and an evaluator review. The coordinator runbook specifies how to invoke the builder, coverage gate, paired rollout gate, and review, and when the accepted parent may change. The adapted instructions below summarize the coordinator's evaluation responsibilities.

Candidate validation

Role. You are the coordinator and evaluator. Control candidate evaluation, and acceptance while keeping the current parent frozen.
Proposal. Predeclare the parent, missing pairs, and development tasks. Provide only development evidence to one proposer. Resume an interrupted proposal rather than generating a duplicate. Wait for its diagnosis, replay, tests, and final report.
Validation. Build the final patch through the fixed builder and run the coverage check. A build or coverage failure consumes the proposal slot and stops candidate evaluation. Otherwise, freeze the candidate and evaluation inputs, then run the predeclared paired plan. Check complete episode accounting, policy, matched initial-state identities, and runtime integrity.
Review. Apply the capability and regression gates. Inspect new successes for genuine physical completion and inspect new regression failures. Numeric passage alone is insufficient. Do not disclose selection or hidden regression details to the proposer.
Decision. Record acceptance or rejection and its evidence. Update the parent only after all required checks and evaluator review pass. On rejection, retain the parent. At the declared stopping point, snapshot the last accepted program and record its lineage.

Check implementation. The builder checks exact patch anchors, the declared module, a forbidden-literal list in inserted text, Python compilation, and supplied `test_*.py` files. Missing tests produce a warning in the inherited builder; the protocol and evaluator require them.

Paired acceptance. Each rollout stage contains `NUM` rows: `NUM` development episodes (seeds 86–95), `NUM` selection episodes (the same tasks, seeds 76–85), `NUM` ordinary-source regression episodes, and `NUM` synthetic-regression episodes. Here "synthetic" denotes instantiated simulator tasks in the protocol. A group's net official gain must be at least two development states and one selection state. Losses are counted separately: at most one state per task per role, and at most one in each regression role. Both stages must pass integrity checks; at most four clean horizon timeouts are permitted. Passing the numeric gate is insufficient: the evaluator must inspect new physical completions and new regression failures.

B Inference Pipeline

Inference executes a frozen shared program. The data-only adapter `adapter_v3.py` constructs descriptors from the public runtime instruction `env.handle.task_language`. To keep general, it does not take a task identifier, scene identifier, seed, or simulator state as input. The program's `la_parse` produces ordered subgoals and `la_dispatch` checks every subgoal before any motion. Unsupported instructions stop explicitly. These functions are deterministic code. The following boxes present concise versions of its localization and identity prompts, using symbolic placeholders for runtime values.

B.1 Object Localization

Revision `NUM` preserves a confident text-based binding and uses VLM localization when text binding fails. The model sees a public camera image, the instruction, the current object phrase, and the execution phase. It returns a pixel or abstains. The point prompts SAM3; masks must contain the point, occupy no more

than 8% of the image, and yield at least 50 deprojected depth points. Only `medium` or `high` confidence proceeds.

Object localization | Initial reference

Context. Task instruction: `{instruction}`. Object phrase: `{phrase}`. Execution phase: `{phase}`.
Image. Image 1 is the current camera view, `{W}` by `{H}` pixels. Coordinates start at the upper left: x indexes columns and y indexes rows.
Task. Identify the single object instance referred to by the instruction, using its spatial qualifiers. Return a pixel at the center of its visible body. Abstain if the instance is ambiguous or not visible.
Response. Return abstain, x, y, confidence, and a brief reason.

When association with the frozen reference fails before grasping, the query includes the initial image with the reference highlighted in magenta. The dimensions `{W}` and `{H}`, instruction, phrase, and phase are runtime substitutions.

Object localization | Reference recovery

Context. Task instruction: `{instruction}`. Object phrase: `{phrase}`. Execution phase: `{phase}`.
Images. Image 1 is the current camera view, `{W}` by `{H}` pixels. Image 2 is the initial view with the reference instance highlighted in magenta. Coordinates in image 1 start at the upper left.
Task. Find the same physical instance in image 1, allowing for objects moved by the robot. Similar-looking objects are different instances. Return a pixel at the center of the visible body. Abstain if the reference cannot be identified confidently or is not visible.
Response. Return abstain, x, y, confidence, and a brief reason.

B.2 Choosing a Whole-Object Mask

SAM3 can return nested masks at one point. At initial binding, a separate query chooses the complete object rather than an inner surface, lid, merged support, or rival instance. Image 1 provides the full view; subsequent images show the highlighted candidate crops. The response selects one candidate image label or abstains. Reference-conditioned localization instead selects among nested masks using the frozen body's size.

Mask selection | Whole-object instance

Context. Task instruction: `{instruction}`. Object phrase: `{phrase}`. Execution phase: `{phase}`.
Images. Image 1 shows the full view with a magenta cross on the proposed object. Each subsequent image shows the same cropped region with one candidate mask highlighted.
Task. Choose the image highlighting exactly the complete requested object instance. Exclude masks covering only a label, lid, or inner surface; masks merged with a neighboring object or support; and masks of another instance.
Response. Return the candidate image label as choice and a brief reason. Return none if no candidate is valid.

B.3 Identity Before Grasping and Transport

The stack freezes object references before any object moves. Before grasping, it associates a point-prompt mask by majority overlap or a 3 cm center-distance bound; failed association invokes reference-conditioned

localization. A confirmed, unchanged reference can bypass another identity query. Otherwise, the cross-frame prompt below returns `yes`, `no`, or `unsure`.

Identity verification | Before grasping

Context. Task instruction: `{instruction}`. Object phrase: `{phrase}`. Execution phase: `{phase}`.
Images. Image 1 highlights the instance identified at task start. Image 2 highlights the current candidate.
Task. Determine whether both highlighted regions refer to the same physical instance. Account for robot-induced motion and use surrounding unmoved objects as context. Similar appearance alone does not establish identity.
Response. Return verdict as yes, no, or unsure, with a brief reason.

After grasping, the query compares the frozen reference, the pregrasp confirmation, and the current lifted object. The template accommodates either two or three images: the pregrasp confirmation is included when available.

Identity verification | After grasping

Context. Task instruction: `{instruction}`. Object phrase: `{phrase}`. Execution phase: `{phase}`.
Images. Image 1 highlights the initial reference. When available, image 2 highlights the pregrasp confirmation. The final image shows the object currently lifted between the fingers.
Task. Determine whether the lifted object is the same physical instance as the highlighted reference. Use the earlier arrangement, the grasped location, and any newly empty location as evidence. Abstain from a positive identity claim when the evidence is insufficient.
Response. Return verdict as yes, no, or unsure, with a brief reason.

Transport requires verified identity, a verified hold, a reached lift, and at least 5 cm of observed object-base rise. A positive model answer alone is insufficient.

B.4 Structured Responses and Runtime Configuration

The point-query schema requires `abstain`, integer `x`/`y`, a confidence enum, and a reason. Identity queries require a verdict enum and a reason; mask-choice queries require `choice` (a candidate image label or `none`) and a reason. Table 5 summarizes the response fields; additional fields are disallowed.

Table 5: Structured outputs for the inference prompts. Every response includes a brief reason.

Query	Required fields	Allowed values
Point localization	`abstain`, `x`, `y`, `confidence`, `reason`	Boolean abstention; integer pixel coordinates; confidence: `low`, `medium`, or `high`.
Mask selection	`choice`, `reason`	A candidate image label, or `none`.
Identity / mask review	`verdict`, `reason`	`yes`, `no`, or `unsure`.

We set the model identifier to `claude-opus-5-5`, effort to `low`, and the default response limit to 3,000 tokens. It sends images and prompt text as one user message with a JSON-schema output format; it adds no separate system prompt. Errors, refusals, truncation, or budget exhaustion return no usable answer and are handled conservatively by the policy.

Execution. Motion-dependent actions use explicit arrival/contact results, and failed transport or release checks invoke bounded recovery. The placement verifier distinguishes `ready_to_release` from `placed` and measures support geometry, identity, gripper clearance, and two-frame stability. However, this snapshot sets `enforce=False` and `corrections=False`: the placement verifier is a shadow monitor, whereas the contact-aware descent gate controls release. At the outer plan level, `run()` logs a subgoal's return value and starts the next subgoal; it does not require the shadow placement verdict to be `success`. Consequently, the implementation should not be described as enforcing every placement postcondition at every skill boundary. Official task completion is measured by the evaluator separately from controller logs.

C Implementation Details

The final artifact should include the shared-stack snapshots, source and target adapters, accepted and rejected patch ledger, evaluator implementation, exact model identifiers, environment revisions, and commands reproducing each table. [Draft: Insert artifact location and the manifests of the completed study.]

C.1 Grasping-backend Mismatch

Our simulation experiments use the open-source Contact-GraspNet backend rather than the AnyGraspFang et al. (2023) backend used in the ASPIRE configuration considered for comparison. This mismatch limits the fairness of a direct performance comparison, because differences in grasp proposal quality may affect both individual manipulation outcomes and long-horizon task completion. Contact-GraspNetSundermeyer et al. (2021) may therefore contribute to the **lower** observed performance, independently of the improvement framework. We expect that using AnyGrasp could improve grasp-dependent execution.

C.2 Adapter and Contract Schemas

[Draft: Document actual adapter fields, permitted relation vocabulary, dependency representation, contract return values, and budget units. Include a source and target example sharing the same executable implementation.]

C.3 Regression Gates

[Draft: Specify the implemented static checks, how identifiers and numeric constants are reviewed, the mechanism-test requirements, paired acceptance thresholds, audit isolation, and rollback behavior. Distinguish automated checks from human review.]

C.4 Source–Target Combination Generalization

[Draft: Provide objects, relations, skill constituents, and complete goal compositions for both suites. Record actual initial-state identities, not seed labels alone, and describe historical development exposure separately from the new frozen evaluation.]

C.5 Resource Accounting

[Draft: Provide per-task/per-axis success, paired outcome counts, confidence intervals, search/generation repeats, candidate costs, execution costs, all failures and retries, and generated-tool counts and usage.]

D LIBERO-Pro Long Zero-Shot Evaluation Details

D.1 Task Manifest and Frozen Execution

The per-task breakdown uses the 10 LIBERO-Pro Long tasks and the Pos/Task variants listed in ASPIRE's zero-shot appendix (Lu et al., 2026). Descriptive task names below follow that appendix; the artifact must map each name to its exact benchmark task ID, instruction, and initial-state manifest. Each task–axis pair uses seeds 1–50 and a fixed task program. All shared code and adapters are finalized before these episodes; target feedback cannot select alternative programs or patches. The artifact records the source task order, final stack hash, generated program and adapter hashes, benchmark revision, seed-to-state mapping, execution horizon, and recovery allowance. [Draft: Populate these manifest fields from the actual run; the seed range and task count describe the adopted ASPIRE setting and must be checked before importing results.]

D.2 Aggregate Results

D.3 Source-Experience Scaling

Figure 7 reserves the source-experience scaling evaluation for frozen RECURSIA stacks after $N \in \{0, 25, 50, 90\}$ source tasks. Each snapshot is selected using source data only and evaluated without target-driven modification. Results remain pending.

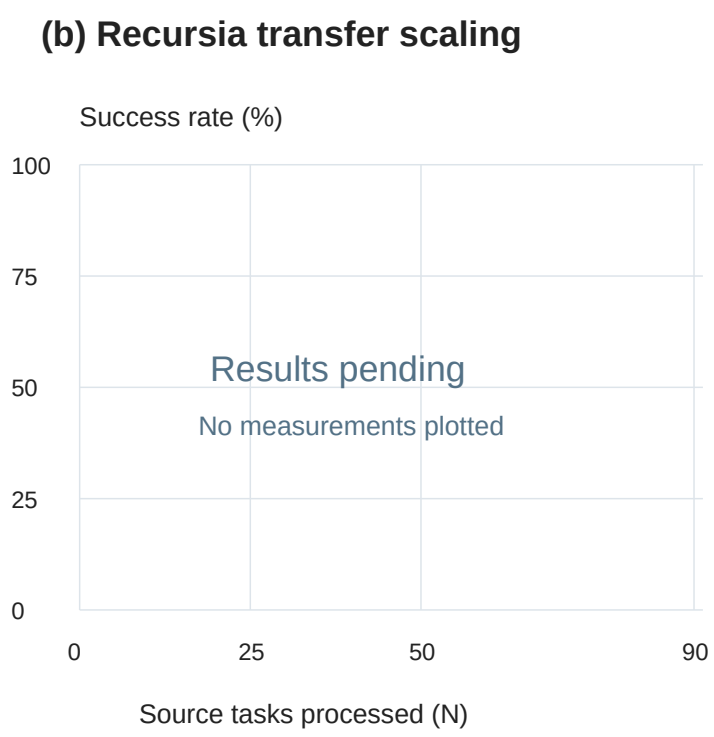


Figure 7: Planned RECURSIA transfer scaling with source-task experience. No measurements are plotted; the panel retains the pending status of the original Figure 3.

D.4 Per-Task Results

Tables 6 and 7 report results per method.

Table 6: LIBERO-Pro Long per-task success under **position perturbations (Pos)**. Each task uses seeds 1–50. ASPIRE values are reproduced from its full-library zero-shot evaluation (Lu et al., 2026); our and Human results remain blank.

Task	OpenVLA	π_0	$\pi_{0.5}$	CaP-Agent0	ASPIRE	Human	RECURSIA
Stove + moka pot	–	–	–	–	1.00		
Bowl in drawer	–	–	–	–	0.00		
Mug in microwave	–	–	–	–	0.00		
Both mokas on stove	–	–	–	–	0.00		
Soup + cream cheese	–	–	–	–	0.00		
Soup + tomato sauce	–	–	–	–	0.00		
Cream cheese + butter	–	–	–	–	0.94		
Mug on two plates	–	–	–	–	0.32		
Mug + pudding	–	–	–	–	0.00		
Book in caddy	–	–	–	–	0.00		

Table 7: LIBERO-Pro Long per-task success under **task-specification perturbations (Task)**. Each task uses seeds 1–50. ASPIRE values are reproduced from its full-library zero-shot evaluation (Lu et al., 2026); our and Human results remain blank.

Task	OpenVLA	π_0	$\pi_{0.5}$	CaP-Agent0	ASPIRE	Human	RECURSIA
Stove + moka pot	–	–	–	–	0.26		
Bowl in drawer	–	–	–	–	0.00		
Mug in microwave	–	–	–	–	0.00		
Both mokas on stove	–	–	–	–	1.00		
Soup + cream cheese	–	–	–	–	0.70		
Soup + tomato sauce	–	–	–	–	0.70		
Cream cheese + butter	–	–	–	–	0.86		
Mug on two plates	–	–	–	–	0.00		
Mug + pudding	–	–	–	–	0.04		
Book in caddy	–	–	–	–	0.26		

D.5 Aggregation

With $y_{ias} \in \{0, 1\}$ denoting official full-task success on seed s, compute

$$\widehat{p}_{ia} = \frac{1}{50} \sum_{s=1}^{50} y_{ias}, \qquad \widehat{p}_{a} = \frac{1}{10} \sum_{i=1}^{10} \widehat{p}_{ia}, \qquad \widehat{p}_{\text{Overall}} = \frac{\widehat{p}_{\text{Pos}} + \widehat{p}_{\text{Task}}}{2}. \tag{7}$$

Our aggregate results are computed from unrounded episode outcomes. Reproduced baseline aggregates retain the source's reported precision. Confidence intervals must account for the grouping of states within tasks, and paired comparisons require matched episode-level outcomes.

D.6 Human Baseline

Human programs use the declared robot interface and permitted observations, be finalized before evaluation, and receive no evaluation-driven repairs or seed-specific branches. We record expert authoring time, development resources, program hashes, and execution budgets. For each reused baseline, we retain the source table or figure, benchmark version, reported generation/retry policy, and available episode metadata. Published aggregate results are reference comparisons, not evidence that all methods share the same model, compute budget, or target execution policy. Matched reruns and the task-program-only improvement control are reported separately when available.